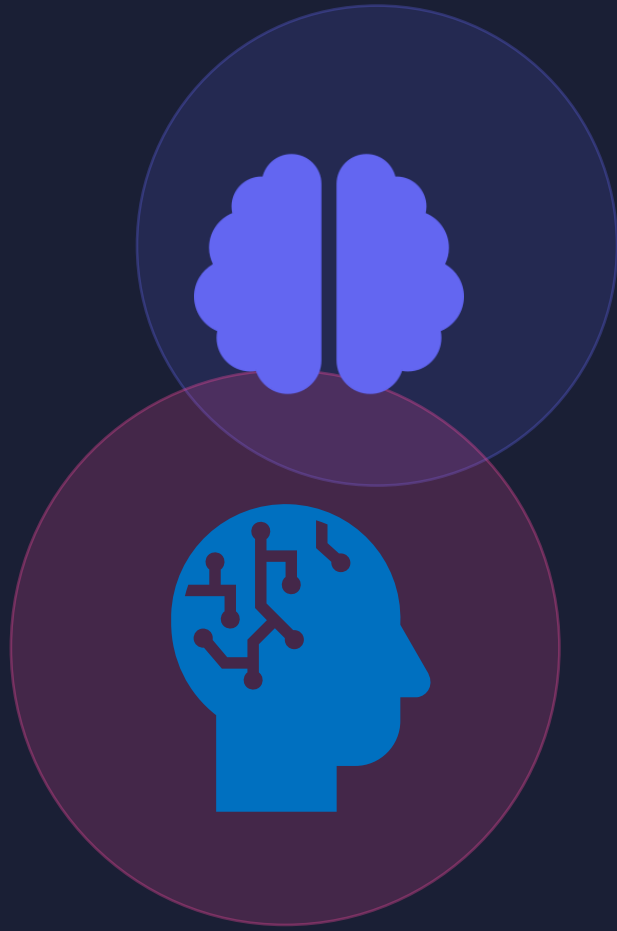
THE BINARY BET

AI as the Great Hope or the Great Disaster

For the next generation of technology leaders

We are watching AI transform the world in real time.
The question is will you be ready?



redgate | About me

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What We'll Cover Today

01

What We Actually Know

Benchmarks, not marketing

02

The Forecasts Shaping Everything

From ethics to scientific discovery

03

The AI Bubble

What's keeping it afloat and what could pop it

04

AGI & Paradigm Shifts

Science fiction or 5-year reality?

05

The Skeptics' Case

Diminishing returns & data quality limits

06

Jobs & The Labor Market

Real data, sector by sector

01

What We Actually Know

Benchmarks, not marketing

Benchmarks, Not Marketing

90%+

Bar passage rate (GPT-4)

Exceeds most humans

Benchmarks, Not Marketing

~$500B

AI investment in 2024

Capital commitment is real

Benchmarks, Not Marketing

3-4x

Coding speed improvement

Documented with LLM assistance

Benchmarks, Not Marketing

50% ↓

Cost per token in 18 months

Rapid commoditization

02

The Forecasts Shaping Everything

Boardrooms & policy tables are acting on these projections

Anthropic's Forecast

ANTHROPIC

Hard Questions on AI Ethics

- Safety as an existential concern, not a PR exercise
- Constitutional AI: baking values into training
- Honest uncertainty about what current models actually understand
- Long-horizon risks are being actively modeled and not dismissed

OpenAI's Forecast

OPENAI

Near-Term Scientific Breakthroughs

- AI will soon make novel scientific discoveries autonomously
- AGI as a realistic near-term milestone, not speculative fiction
- Agentic AI taking multi-step autonomous actions at scale
- Economic transformation projected to outpace regulatory capacity

Microsoft’s Forecast

Microsoft

AI Baked Into Every Product

- AI should be the forefront of every product solution
- Low-code/No-Code options with AI beneficial to every user
- Democratize ALL the data
- Make all users AI savvy

03

The AI Bubble

What's keeping it afloat and what could pop it

What's Keeping the Bubble Afloat

What's Keeping It Afloat

- Genuine productivity gains in software, legal, finance
- Massive capex commitments ($500B+) create path dependency
- Rapid cost reduction sustains new use cases
- Network effects from early adopters

The Single Weak Link

The Single Weak Link

- ROI still unproven at enterprise scale
- Compute infrastructure may outpace real demand (Oracle?)
- There will be winners and real losers
- Interconnected investment

What To Watch For

What To Watch

- Enterprise contract renewals (2025–2026)
- AI-native companies vs. incumbents' AI layers
- Legal liability decisions and state/country regulations
- Let’s talk the AI “Snake-oil Salesmen”

04

AGI & Paradigm Shifts

Science fiction or 5-year reality?

Where We Are Today

NOW

Narrow AI dominates

LLMs perform remarkably on bounded tasks; still fail in novel, multi-step reasoning scenarios

2026: The Inflection Year

2026

Agentic AI at scale

Autonomous agents completing multi-step professional workflows without human supervision

2027–28: Wave of Capability

2027–28

Potential AGI threshold

Some labs define AGI as AI that can perform any cognitive task a human can. Are LLMs the path?

2030+: The Long Horizon

2030+

Post-LLM paradigm?

Researchers debate whether transformer-based LLMs will still be dominant… or replaced entirely

05

The Skeptics' Case

Giving the critics their due…because I am the devil’s advocate.

Giving the Critics Their Due

These arguments deserve honest engagement, not dismissal.

Diminishing Returns on Scale

Each new LLM generation requires dramatically more compute for smaller performance gains. The 'just scale it' playbook may be approaching physical and economic limits.

Giving the Critics Their Due

These arguments deserve honest engagement, not dismissal.

The Data Quality Problem

The internet was scraped and we know what’s on the internet.
Garbage in, garbage out.
What's left? Models trained on AI-generated content may degrade over time…and a structural flaw, not an engineering fix.

Giving the Critics Their Due

These arguments deserve honest engagement, not dismissal.

Reasoning vs. Pattern Matching

Critics argue LLMs are sophisticated autocomplete, not reasoning engines, as well as incredibly confident. Benchmark performance may not transfer to genuinely novel, real-world problems.

Giving the Critics Their Due

These arguments deserve honest engagement, not dismissal.

Reliability Gap

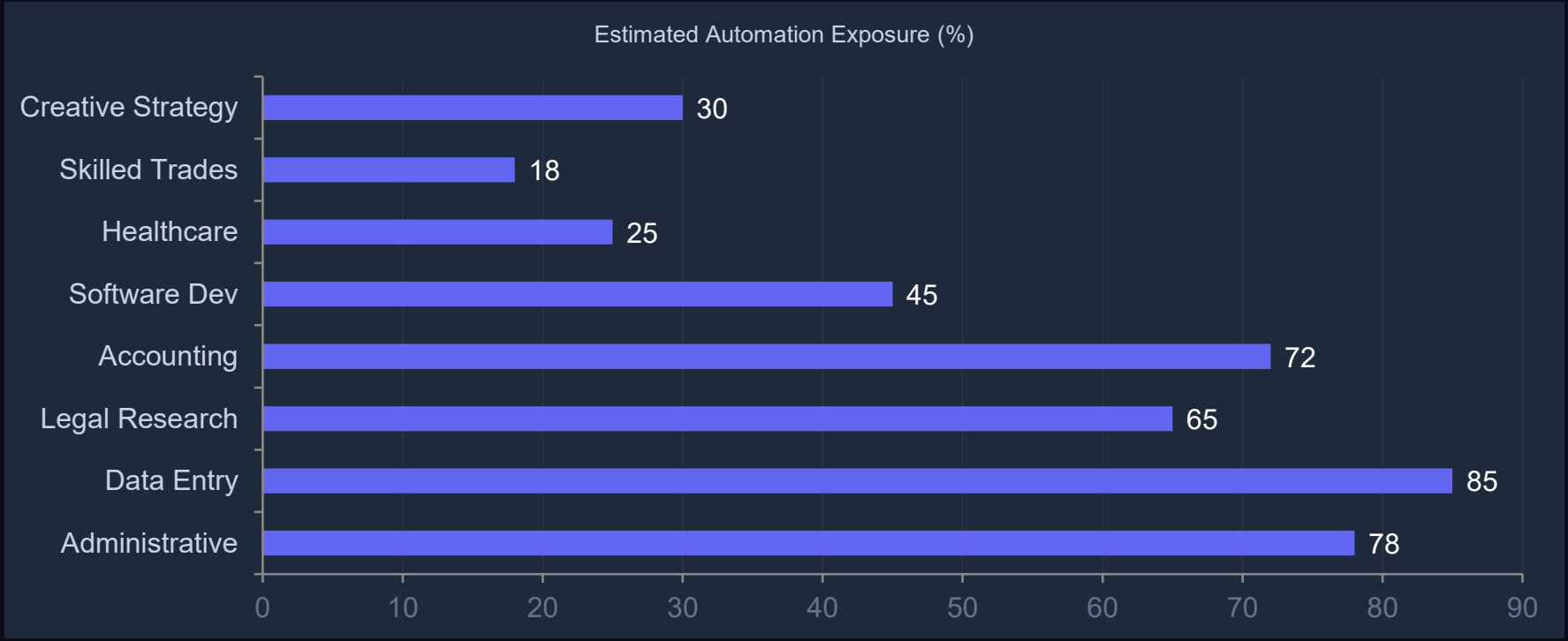
Hallucination rates remain unacceptable for high-stakes domains (medicine, law, engineering). The gap between 'impressive demo' and 'trusted system' is still large.

06

Jobs & The Labor Market

Sector by sector…real data, no clickbait

Sector by Sector: Real Data, No Clickbait



Sector by Sector: Real Data, No Clickbait

Key Insights

- Augmentation, not just replacement, but change, fewer jobs disappear entirely
- New jobs created: AI trainers, auditors, safety evaluators, prompt engineers
- Speed of displacement may exceed speed of retraining programs
- Wage polarization risk: high-skill premium rises, routine-task wages compress
- The ability to navigate from entry-level to expert is gutted from AI. How do we train the next generation to take over?

You Will Inherit These Decisions.

This talk is for the people who intend to show up for that moment and be ready.

Stay Honest

Cut through hype with benchmarks. The signal is there, but you just have to know where to look.

Stay Curious

The paradigm may shift. The leaders who adapt to what comes after LLMs will define the next era.

Show Up Ready

AI will touch everything you build, manage, and decide. That's not a threat, but it's your leverage.

Learning References:

- Microsoft AI Learning Hub
- Microsoft AI Skills for Everyone
- Google AI Essentials
- AWS AI Skills Builder

Meetups

- Portland Women in Tech(PDXWIT)
- AI Portland
- Portland AI Engineers

Thank you!

If you want to connect with me: